

CURRENT AFFAIRS



CPEC



46th WEEK 2016

UPSC

CAPSULE - 3

ALL EXAMS

14th Nov to 20th Nov

FACTUAL INFORMATION

- 1 Gwadar port was made operational, which is part of CPEC.
- 2 It is in trouble-torn Balochistan Province of Pakistan.
- 3 The port was opened with a Chinese ship exporting goods to the Middle East and Africa.
- 4 This is being developed by the Chinese in Pakistan.
- 5 Pakistan expects huge gains for the country with this CPEC project.









Kashgar City

CHINA

Pakistan

INDIA

Gwadar Port

Strait of Hormuz

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

Straits of Malacca

VIETNAM

THAILAND

MALAYSIA

INDONESIA

PHILIPPINES

Philippines

South Korea

East China Sea

South China Sea

Gulf of Thailand

MYANMAR (BURMA)

BANGLADESH

NEPAL

AFGHANISTAN

TURKMENISTAN

KYRGYZSTAN

UZBEKISTAN

IRAN

OMAN

ARABIA

YEMEN

ALIA

MORE ABOUT CPEC



- 1 It is the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor.
- 2 It is a 46 billion dollar project.
- 3 This was conceived much earlier in 1950s.
- 4 Could not take off due to political instability in Pakistan.
- 5 However, Chinese Government announced it in November, 2014.
- 6 Work started in April, 2015.
- 7 Gwadar port was initially made operational in November, 2016.
- 8 It connects Gwadar port in Pakistan with Xinjiang Province of the north-western region of China.
- 9 It takes off in trouble-torn Balochistan and passes through Pakistan occupied territory of Gilgit-Baltistan.





MORE ABOUT CPEC

- 10** Out of \$ 46 billion, overall \$ 34 billion will be spent to generate 17,000 megawatts through coal, nuclear and other renewable energy projects.
- 11** Balance will be utilized for developing transport infrastructure.
- 12** If you look at FDI, this 46 billion dollar investment is equal to twice the amount of foreign investment the country has received since 2008.
- 13** It is part of the 'One Belt, One Road' (OBOR) initiative of China. The 'One Belt, One Road' initiative aims to connect Asian economic giant with Europe and Africa.
- 14** The initiative of 'One Belt, One Road' of China will make the country to play a bigger role in the world's economic affairs.
- 15** It is touted to be the game changer for Pakistan and the Prime Minister stated that Balochistan could make Pakistan a regional hub of economic activities.
- 16** Balochistan is the largest province in Pakistan, which has a high concentration of natural resources.

CPEC ... CHALLENGES

- 1** The main problem is conflict in Balochistan region. When Balochistan was made part of Pakistan, then it was promised for regional autonomy. But as the Pakistan Government failed to keep the promises, alienation of Baloch people took place and separatist groups like Baloch Republican Party came to the forefront and fighting against the Government.
- 2** There are allegations that Pakistan army is resorting to abductions and missing of several Baloch people is being reported everyday in Balochistan Province and this made the things further worse.
- 3** Though Balochistan is the largest province in Pakistan, but the domination by Punjab region people is quite evident in Pakistan, both politically and economically and there is a feeling in Balochistan that people from Punjab origin may migrate to Balochistan so as to alter the demography of Balochistan region.
- 4** The security is the biggest challenge and as per the news reports, Pakistan is making special efforts to ensure the security of Chinese officials. However, in the initial stages, no Chinese authorities are involved in the construction in Balochistan.
- 5** As it passes through Gilgit-Baltistan region, India already protested against the project.





- 1 It may alter the relationship permanently between Pakistan and China towards the close strategic relationship, but Pakistan and the USA relations may further widen.
- 2 The relations between India and China may strain because this passes through Gilgit-Baltistan region which is Pakistan occupied Kashmir Territory.
- 3 Economic development of Pakistan depends on the security scenario in Pakistan as well as bringing Baloch people to the national mainstream by the Pakistani Government.
- 4 With the victory of Donald Trump, the relations between Russia and the USA are likely to improve and if this happens then what will happen to the China-Russia-Pakistan axes is not clear.
- 5 If India does not fast track Chabahar port in adjacent Iran and subsequent connectivity to Central Asia, then Central Asia may tilt towards CPEC to have access to China.

One has to wait and see how this project integrates the psych of Balochistan Province people with Pakistan and Xinjiang Province people with China!





K A Z A K H S T A N

M O N G O L

U Z B E K I S T A N

T U R K M E N I S T A N

K Y R G Y Z S T A N

T A J I K I S T A N

Ashgabat

I R A N

A F G H A N I S T A N

C H I N A

Chabahar port

P A K I S T A N

Gwadar port

N E P A L

B H U T A N

B A N G L A D E S H

M Y A N M A R
(B U R M A)

I N D I A

S A U D I A R A B I A

O M A N

Y e m e n

Persian Gulf